

MUNICIPALITIES - CONTINUOUS AT-A-GLANCE MASTER

Core -> origin -> Part IXA -> democracy -> devolution -> finance -> planning -> cases -> reform

01

CORE QUESTION

- 1
- Can the elected urban institution control the services for which residents hold it answerable?
- 2
- Municipality = Article 243Q institution of self-government; authority remains State-law mediated.
- 3
- Answer line: constitutional status is not the same as operational autonomy.

ANSWER USE: CORE QUESTION - connect the exact rule to its mechanism and limit.

02

ORIGIN AND CONSTITUTIONAL TURN

- KEY
- 1688 Madras -> 1726 Bombay/Calcutta -> Mayo 1870 -> Ripon 1882 -> Hobhouse 1907-09.
- KEY
- 65th Bill 1989 failed; revised 1990 Bill lapsed; 74th Amendment 1992 effective 1 June 1993.
- KEY
- 1919 transferred subject -> 1935 provincial subject -> finance/staff/urbanisation committees.

ANSWER USE: ORIGIN AND CONSTITUTIONAL TURN - connect the exact rule to its mechanism and limit.

03

PART IXA SPINE

- 1
- 243P definitions; 243Q types; 243R composition; 243S wards; 243T reservation.
- 2
- 243U duration; 243V disqualification; 243W functions; 243X finance; 243Y SFC; 243Z audit.
- 3
- 243ZA elections; ZB UTs; ZC exclusions; ZD DPC; ZE MPC; ZF transition; ZG election bar.

ANSWER USE: PART IXA SPINE - connect the exact rule to its mechanism and limit.

04

TYPES, COMPOSITION AND PARTICIPATION

- 1
- Nagar Panchayat transitional -> Municipal Council smaller -> Corporation larger.
- 2
- Industrial township is a notified exception, not a fourth ordinary type.
- 3
- Territorial seats direct from wards; experts non-voting; chairperson method by State law.
- 4
- Wards Committee mandatory at municipal population >= 3 lakh; area sabha needs legal grounding.

ANSWER USE: TYPES, COMPOSITION AND PARTICIPATION - connect the exact rule to its mechanism and limit.

05

RESERVATION, TENURE AND ELECTIONS

- KEY
- SC/ST seats by municipal population; women >= one-third inclusive; State may enhance women.
- KEY
- Five years from first meeting; hearing before dissolution; election before expiry/within six months.
- KEY
- Backward-class reservation is enabling; Krishna Murthy + Gawali triple-test safeguards.
- KEY
- SEC under 243ZA; Kishansing Tomar timing; Fouziya independence; 243ZG election-petition route.

ANSWER USE: RESERVATION, TENURE AND ELECTIONS - connect the exact rule to its mechanism and limit.

06

DEVOLUTION AND THE 18 MATTERS

- KEY
- 243W and Twelfth Schedule are enabling, not self-executing.
- KEY
- Test devolution by activity, decision right, staff, asset, budget, standard and grievance authority.
- KEY
- Planning/land: roads/water/fire; health/sanitation/SWM; environment; inclusion; amenities; civic systems.

ANSWER USE: DEVOLUTION AND THE 18 MATTERS - connect the exact rule to its mechanism and limit.

07

FINANCE, AUDIT AND EQUALISATION

- KEY
- 243X: State-authorised own taxes/fees + assignments + grants + funds.
- KEY
- 243Y SFC + 280(3)(c) UFC supplementation; grants cannot replace State devolution.
- KEY
- Property tax needs complete base, transparent valuation, collection and appeal; user charges need equity.
- KEY
- 243Z State-law accounts/audit; CAG technical support is not automatic sole audit.

ANSWER USE: FINANCE, AUDIT AND EQUALISATION - connect the exact rule to its mechanism and limit.

08

DPC AND MPC

- KEY
- DPC 243ZD: at least 4/5 elected; rural/urban population ratio; consolidates district plans.
- KEY
- Both consider shared resources/infrastructure/environment and forward plans to State Government.
- KEY
- MPC 243ZE: at least 2/3 elected; municipal/Panchayat population ratio; metropolitan draft plan.
- KEY
- Planning committee is not automatically an executive regional government.

ANSWER USE: DPC AND MPC - connect the exact rule to its mechanism and limit.

09

URBAN EXECUTIVE AND FRAGMENTATION

- 1
- Mayor/council policy visibility versus commissioner/staff implementation control varies by State.
- 2
- Parastatals may control land, water, transport or housing; SPVs may hold mission contracts.
- 3
- Reform: clear statutory roles, council-approved outcomes, service agreements, shared data and O&M rules.

ANSWER USE: URBAN EXECUTIVE AND FRAGMENTATION - connect the exact rule to its mechanism and limit.

10

OUTSIDE PART IXA AND URBAN TRANSITION

- KEY
- Cantonment Board: Cantonments Act 2006, central/Defence statutory local authority.
- KEY
- Development authorities and special agencies derive only from their statute/notification/company documents.
- KEY
- Major Port Authority: central Major Port Authorities Act 2021; not a municipality.
- KEY
- Census town != statutory municipality; transition needs criteria, consultation and protected representation.

ANSWER USE: OUTSIDE PART IXA AND URBAN TRANSITION - connect the exact rule to its mechanism and limit.

11

PROGRAMMES, SERVICES AND REFORM

- 1
- Smart Cities 2015 SPV, AMRUT 2.0 2021 and SBM-U 2.0 2021 are dated programmes, not constitutional bodies.
- 2
- Integrate land use, mobility, water, sanitation, waste, public health, climate and informal settlements.
- 3
- Reform chain: activity maps -> cadres -> OSR/SFC -> DPC/MPC -> audit -> service outcomes.

ANSWER USE: PROGRAMMES, SERVICES AND REFORM - connect the exact rule to its mechanism and limit.

12

TRAPS, CASES AND ANSWER SPINE

- 1
- Traps: 1 June 1993; Twelfth = 18; Ward threshold 3 lakh; metro threshold 10 lakh; DPC 4/5; MPC 2/3.
- 2
- Cases: Kishansing Tomar; Fouziya; Krishna Murthy; Gawali; Rahul Ramesh Wagh orders; Suresh Mahajan.
- 3
- Answer spine: define -> constitutional floor -> State-law gap -> named evidence -> reform -> qualification.
- 4
- Verdict: subsidiarity needs accountable coordination where urban scale creates externalities.

ANSWER USE: TRAPS, CASES AND ANSWER SPINE - connect the exact rule to its mechanism and limit.

QUALIFIED VERDICT: empower the elected municipality, coordinate transparently where scale crosses borders.